

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 171

By Haile

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend School Resource Officer Chris Jennings of the Sumner County Sheriff's Office.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly take great pride in recognizing those venerable law enforcement officers who are devoted to serving their communities; and

WHEREAS, one such individual is School Resource Officer (SRO) Chris Jennings of the Sumner County Sheriff's Office, who was recently recognized by the National Association of School Resource Officers (NASRO) for his dedication to school-based policing; and

WHEREAS, assigned to Robert E. Ellis Middle School in Hendersonville, SRO Jennings recently earned his NASRO Practitioner status, which recognizes officers who have excelled in the field and are committed to serving youth, schools, and communities; and

WHEREAS, to earn the distinction, officers must meet several requirements, including at least three years of experience as an SRO, completion of basic and advanced SRO training courses, 160 hours of specialized school safety training, attendance at a NASRO School Safety Conference, and submission of an application with supporting documentation; and

WHEREAS, a native of California, SRO Chris Jennings began his law enforcement career with the Tulare County, California, Sheriff's Office, where he served for eighteen years in corrections, patrol, field training, narcotics, and SWAT, before ending his time there as a detective sergeant. He then moved to Visalia, California, where he worked in patrol and as a violent crimes detective; before his retirement in July 2020, after thirty years of service, he was promoted to sergeant and supervised patrol of the K-9 unit and peer support team; and

WHEREAS, relocating to Sumner County, he joined the Sumner County Sheriff's Office as a school resource officer and has spent the past four years at Robert E. Ellis Middle School;

he has risen to team leader for a group of five deputies, serves as a field training officer, and is a peer support team special investigation team member; and

WHEREAS, SRO Jennings is also licensed as a school counselor in Tennessee and holds a bachelor's degree in social and criminal justice and a master's degree in education; and

WHEREAS, a devoted husband and father, Chris Jennings enjoys the love and support of his wife, Misti, a former school principal in California and a current professional school counselor in Sumner County, and their four children; and

WHEREAS, this esteemed law enforcement professional has brought honor to the State of Tennessee and should be recognized on this special occasion; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we hereby honor and commend School Resource Officer Chris Jennings of the Sumner County Sheriff's Office upon his recognition by the National Association of School Resource Officers as we extend our best wishes for much continued success in all his future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.